

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-zdx7-tfko
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: Web

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-5785

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

Good evening—

I am a small business owner and artist, and generative AI has become a major problem for myself, my family, and my community. For years, myself and my fellow creators have worked hard to develop the skills and knowledge to run our businesses, and we have never been shy about helping and teaching others how to do the same. Until recently, we were able to carve out a small, manageable existence and support our families through our work. We have been happy to share our work with the world through the magic of the internet, and even grown our businesses that way.

Generative AI technology, and the corporations that own it, have stolen, destroyed, and exploited the fruits of our labor without our consent, and now are claiming that the only way to further ‘American innovation’ is to roll over and let them take more. I say that if their product is worthless without theft, then it is not worth anything at all.

If you truly want to protect American innovation, you would protect American creators. Do not create new copyright exemptions that allow Big Tech companies to exploit and steal from creators and everyday Americans without permission, compensation, or transparency.

This administration’s AI Action Plan should focus not on giving away creator content to Big Tech companies, but rather on ensuring a fair marketplace with competition, and I have three steps below working towards that:

First, the government should ensure that creators and everyday Americans give effective consent, so that we can decide when and where our work is used by AI systems.

Second, the AI Action Plan should encourage a robust licensing marketplace, so that the incentive to create for small businesses is preserved. Our work has immense economic value, so the value generated by that work should accrue to the original creators, not just Big Tech.

Finally, the AI Action Plan should require transparency from Big Tech companies, requiring them to disclose what material is in their training datasets, and label what content is AI generated.

I am not anti-technology or anti-AI. I have done my research on the arguments for both sides, and the technology used by these companies. I am impressed by the capabilities of these AI systems, and see they can be incredibly useful for many things. But we should not sacrifice the hard work of hundreds of thousands of Americans and give it away to Big Tech by rewriting copyright law.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on these important issues, and may god guide you on your decision.